HOLODECK · LINKS

Link surfaces: what each view is for

Six views read the same set of links between sources. This brief states what each one has to accomplish, so the layout can be redesigned around those jobs. It leads with the one rule they all share.

> THE RULE
>
> A link is useless unless it says what came to light. Every view leads with the finding: what the two passages establish together, with the exact words marked. The relation name and the provenance come second.

What every view has to do

Lead with the finding

A kind label, one sentence saying what is established, and the words themselves marked in both passages. “Related” and “says about” are not findings.

Say how sure it is

Inferred, computed, from a file, or confirmed by a person must look different at a glance. A pair that does not beat chance is shown as such, never asserted.

Show what is missing

Silence is information: a passage nothing answers, a heading the resolution never names, a document that is not on file. These need a place in every view, not only in a list.

Let sources switch on and off in place

One click on a source removes it from every view and every count. Nothing reloads, nothing is lost, and the same switch state holds when the person moves to another view.

Reach the words in one step

From any finding, one click opens the passage in the reader with the marked words underlined. The gutter in the reader says the same thing as the views.

Stay read-only

Only Review writes a link. Everywhere else a person can look, filter and open, and cannot change a link by accident.

Scale without a hairball

From two sources to fifty, from twenty links to two thousand. When there are too many to draw, show ranked groups and counts, led by the findings that matter.

Work in a narrow column

The Holodeck sits beside other panes and on a phone. Nothing may depend on a wide canvas to be understood.

The kinds of finding a layout has to tell apart

Findings come from the engine's own reading across the sources, not from phrases written into the interface. Each is either **licensed**, because it cleared a null, or **possible**, a candidate the engine holds below the line. The layout must make that difference visible on every card, every line and every underline.

LABEL	WHAT IT SAYS	MARKED WORDS	WEIGHT
DIFFERENT FIGURES	The same thing is stated with two different numbers or dates.	Both figures.	Highest. Act on it.
DENIED	One source denies what the other states, over the same subject.	The negation and the subject words, both sides.	Highest.
SPOKEN OF, NOT HELD	A source speaks of a thing in several differently-modified ways (the existing contract, the new contract), and no source says any of them.	The modified phrases.	High interest, but never licensed: the engine can only say it is a candidate. It needs its own visual place, because the thing has no passage to point at.

LABEL	WHAT IT SAYS	MARKED WORDS	WEIGHT
NOT NAMED	A source names another source (by carrying its title), and that source holds words the naming source never writes while two or more other sources return to them.	The word in the named text, and where the other source raised it.	High. Licensed only when the set beats chance; otherwise shown as “possible”. A whole-source relation with a few marks on one side.
REFERS TO	One passage carries most of another source’s title, so it names that source without any cue phrase.	The title words inside the passage.	Structural. It is what makes the “Not named” finding possible.
DEFINED AS	A phrase is named inside the definition of a term in another source (an ordinance defining “surveillance technology”).	The phrase, and the definition.	Medium.
BOTH STATE	The same figure or date appears in both.	The figure.	Confirms. Quiet.
SAME SUBJECT	The two share distinctive words and nothing stronger.	The shared words.	Lowest. Never leads.
CITES	One source cites a section of another, and the citation lands on a passage.	The citation and the passage it lands on.	Structural.

The test record: Motorola contract RS2026-2264

Four sources are loaded: the council debate record of 6 October 2026, Metro Code 13.08.080 on surveillance technology, the resolution with its cooperative-purchase certification, and the Sourcewell master agreement 030425-MOT with Motorola

Solutions. A redesign passes when a person who has never seen the record can state both findings below within ten seconds of opening any one view.

Council debate 2026-10-06 · Metro Code 13.08.080 · Resolution and certification · Sourcewell agreement 030425-MOT

NOT NAMED

The resolution did not match what the exhibit said

The resolution approves the attached agreement as public safety software for Emergency Communications, and the certification justifies it as dispatch. The attached agreement also lists **Drone Software and Hardware**, video surveillance solutions and more. The resolution never names any of them, and the certification answers the surveillance question **No**.

> “In this exhibit, there are drones that may be purchased with this.” public comment, debate record

Four sources are involved: the resolution, the attachment, the certification and the debate. One finding needs to connect all four.

SPOKEN OF, NOT HELD

There was no prior contract on file

Council members asked for the **existing contract** to compare with the new one, and it was **not on a government website**. The last one on the portal dates from 2009, and the record shows work continuing without a contract since June. The only Motorola contract in this workspace is the new one.

> “I don't feel comfortable right now having not reviewed the existing contract because it's not available.” council member, debate record

The absent thing has no passage to point at. The layout has to give an absence a visible place.

The six views

Each card gives the question the view answers, what it has to show, what it must not do, and the layout problems to solve. The order in the navigation today is Lanes, Margin, Seam, Orbit, Fields, Review, with a count of 91 on Review for links waiting for a decision.

LANES

How are these sources related, and where do they touch?

GOAL	One overview of every source on a shared axis: media time for recordings, document order for text. A line joins two passages and says what it establishes.
MUST SHOW	• Which source pairs are tied, and how densely. • Where the findings are (differences, denials, left out) before the ordinary links. • Which links are inferred, which are confirmed.
MUST NOT	Turn into a hairball at a few hundred links, or hide a whole-source finding because it has no position on the axis.
OPEN PROBLEM	A finding such as “Not named” joins a passage to a whole document and has no place on a lane. The Ground, Figure and Pattern control (ambient field, each specific link, recurring structure) works, but its meaning is not obvious from the labels.

MARGIN

Is what I am about to say supported, contradicted, or unanswered?

GOAL	A person writes or pastes a draft. Each sentence shows what the sources say about it, and what nothing in the workspace answers.
MUST SHOW	• A contradiction before a support. • Unanswered sentences as clearly as answered ones. • The words that matched, in the sentence and in the source.
MUST NOT	Save or send the draft, or write to a source. The draft stays in the browser.
OPEN PROBLEM	A fixed 250px side gutter cramps long quotes and collapses on a phone. Several partners per sentence need a way to be ranked and folded.

SEAM

Where do these two sources disagree, and what does one leave out?

GOAL	Two chosen sources aligned side by side. Each passage sits beside its partner, or beside nothing. Nothing is merged.
MUST SHOW	• Same, differs, extends or alone for every row, and the finding sentence for every row that has one. • What came to light between exactly these two, including the whole-source findings that are not row pairs. • A denial against the several statements it denies, which is one-to-many.
MUST NOT	Imply a pair is a match because it sits in the same row. A weak pair must say so.
OPEN PROBLEM	The three-column grid has a very narrow middle column. Long statements and the “Differences only” and “Overprint” modes need a clearer relationship to the default view.

ORBIT

What is the centre of this record, and what hangs off it?

GOAL	A map where sources are planets and linked passages are moons. The nearer a body sits, the more strongly it is tied. Click a body to make it the centre.
MUST SHOW	• Findings as visibly different ties (red for differs or denied, amber for left out), not only as a heavier line. • Sources that are tied to nothing, so their isolation is seen. • The same source switches as the other views.
MUST NOT	Show a physics toy. The distance has to mean something a reader can state.
OPEN PROBLEM	Moon labels collide. There is no cue that a click re-centres, and no way to read the finding behind a tie without leaving the map.

FIELDS

What has nothing to say to anything else?

GOAL	Coverage. Each source as a strip of its passages: linked, linked and differing, linked only by inference, or touching nothing.
MUST SHOW	• The share of each source that is silent. • Citations that point at nothing, such as a section number with no source behind it. • Which silent passages are likely to matter, so that “untouched” is not just a count.
MUST NOT	Treat silence as a fault. Some sources are meant to stand alone.
OPEN PROBLEM	A source with two thousand passages reduces to an unreadable bar. The unresolved citations are a list at the bottom, far from the strip they belong to.

REVIEW

What should I decide next?

GOAL	The one place a link is written. Inferred links wait here. Confirm turns a dotted line solid everywhere. Reject removes it. Change relation corrects its type. Every decision records who and when.
MUST SHOW	• The queue ranked by what each link establishes, with differences, denials and left-out items first. • The finding and the marked words on the card, so a decision can be made without opening anything. • Progress: decided today, confirmed, still waiting.
MUST NOT	Present ninety-one cards as one flat scroll, or let a decision be made without seeing both passages.
OPEN PROBLEM	Queue length. It needs grouping (by source pair, by kind), a way to decide several at once when they say the same thing, and keyboard decisions.

Shared furniture that belongs to every view

Sources bar. One chip per source with its colour, a single click to switch it off or on, double-click to keep only that one, and a panel with search for a long list (All, None, Only linked). It has to stay quick at fifty sources and be reachable in the narrow column.

Grain control. Ground shows how sources are tied, Figure shows each specific link, Pattern shows only what recurs. It appears on Lanes and Orbit only. The words need to mean something to a person who does not know the model.

Filters. By kind of relation and by how sure (confirmed and computed only, or everything including inferred). The counts beside each chip must follow the source switches.

Passage card. A read-only side panel for one span and every link that touches it: the finding, both passages with their marks, and a button to open each in the reader.

Reader gutter. In the reader, only the words that carry a finding are underlined, with a column of notes at the height of each. Red for differs and denied, amber for left out. Click for the card.

Navigation. The Links group in the sidebar, with a count on Review. The order and grouping are open: Review might lead, and the count might say how many are findings rather than all inferred.

Constraints

- Dark and light themes. The app's graphite neutrals stay. The only added colour is one hue per source, plus red for differs and denied and amber for left out. Colour is never the only signal: use form, weight or a label as well.
- Body text no smaller than 13px. Quotes are in a serif face, interface text in a sans, identifiers and labels in a monospace.
- Works at 400px wide with no sideways scroll. The two-passage layout stacks.
- No internal terminology on screen. The words are source, link, finding, passage and review.
- The views are read-only; only Review writes. Any new control that edits a link belongs in Review or the passage card's decision buttons, nowhere else.

What to explore

- A shared “findings” strip that appears in the same position in every view, so the same finding is recognised wherever the person is.

- A visual form for an absence: a document that is not on file, a heading that is not named, a passage nothing answers.
- How a finding that connects four sources (resolution, attachment, certification, debate) is drawn once and not four times.
- Whether Seam, Lanes and Orbit are three views or one view with three lenses, given they share sources, filters and the passage card.
- A Review queue that can be cleared in a sitting: grouping, batch decisions, and a clear finish.